A GRAND CELEBRATION OF DANCE



The month-long Indian Dance Festival in Mamallapuram is a homage to India's great classical dance forms in a setting that is as spectacular as it gets.

There cannot be a more scenic or a prestigious location for a dance festival than the Shore Temple of Mamallapuram 'a UNESCO World Heritage Site' which sits along the Bay of Bengal coastline.

Every year between December-January, the tranquil shore town of Mamallapuram wakes up to the gentle sound of the anklets. The splendid sight of the performance of most accomplished classical dancers across India accompanied with robust melody of drums can be witnessed at the prestigious Indian Dance Festival.

The remarkable little town, known as Mamallapuram, sits an hour's drive south of Chennai on one of India's most scenic routes—the East Coast Road. Once a celebrated port city of the Pallava kings, it is the home to a group of monuments dating back to 7th and 8th centuries, which were carved out of rock along the Coromandel coast. Notable among them are the rathas (temples in the form of chariots), mandapas (cave sanctuaries), giant open-air reliefs such as the famous 'Descent of the Ganges' (locally called 'Arjuna's Penance'), and the stunning Shore Temple.

The Indian Dance Festival—which began in 1992 as the Mamallapuram Dance Festival—attracts visitors from all over the world and is considered a great honour to perform at the Indian Dance Festival, and the biggest names in the Indian dance fraternity turn up for it. Each dance tell tales from the epics and other ancient lore, as they always have. The repertoire of dance forms includes Kathak, Kathakali, Kuchipudi, Bharatanatyam, Odissi, Mohiniyattam, and many more. Indeed, the entire range of India's refined classical dances come together to offer a feast for the eyes.

Best of all, the festival provides a platform for not just classical dance forms but lesser-known folk dance traditions like Kavadi, Thappattam, Karagam, Oyilattam, and so on. This makes the festival a vibrant event marked by colourful performances.

During the festival, the front lawn of the Shore Temple transforms into a stage. With the magnificent temple serving as the backdrop, the dance performances are nothing short of magic.

A visit to the Indian Dance Festival is a dream come true for both performing artists as well as passionate art enthusiasts. And few dance festivals can claim a venue as mesmerising as this one.



WHERE
SEA SHORE TEMPLE COMPLEX,
MAMALLAPURAM, CHENNAI

WHEN
DECEMBER 23RD,2022 TO JANUARY 12TH, 2023

TIMINGS
5:30 PM - 8:30 PM

WEBSITE FOR MORE INFORMATION
https://www.tamilnadutourism.tn.gov.in/

STAY AT
Beach Resort Complex
Mamallapuram - 603 104